坐火车去西安

四十年以后，爷爷又去西安了

The Fast Train to Xi'an

Forty years on, Grandpa goes back to Xi'an

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 2 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 刘洋[†]是大学生，今年二十岁。放假了，他要和爷爷一起从北京坐火车去西安[‡]。爷爷今年七十岁了。他年轻的时候去过西安，那是四十多年以前的事了。西安是一个很老、很有名的地方。很久很久以前，它是中国最重要的地方。现在，很多中国人和外国人都去那里看看。

爷爷去过西安

2 刘洋问爷爷：“爷爷，您去过西安。那时候坐火车要多长时间？”爷爷说：“一天一夜。那时候的火车很慢，车上的人也非常多。我的票没有座位，只能站着。站累了，我就坐在地上。”

3 刘洋说：“现在的火车比那时候快多了。我们早上八点上车，十二点多就到西安了。”爷爷不相信：“一天一夜的路，四个多小时就到？我没坐过这么快的火车。”

† 刘洋 *Liú Yáng* Liu Yang, a student

‡ 西安 *Xī'ān* Xi'an, an old city

Liu Yang is a university student. He is twenty this year. The holidays had started, and he was going to take the train from Beijing to Xi'an with his grandfather. Grandpa was seventy this year. He had been to Xi'an when he was young, more than forty years ago. Xi'an is a very old and famous place. Long, long ago it was the most important place in China. Today lots of Chinese people and foreigners go there to have a look around. 1

Grandpa Has Been to Xi'an

Liu Yang asked, "Grandpa, you've been to Xi'an. How long did the train take back then?" "A day and a night," said Grandpa. "The trains were very slow then, and terribly crowded. My ticket had no seat, so I had to stand. When I got tired of standing, I sat on the floor." 2

"Trains today are much faster than back then," said Liu Yang. "We'll get on at eight in the morning and be in Xi'an soon after twelve." Grandpa didn't believe him. "A day-and-a-night journey in just over four hours? I've never been on a train that fast." 3

3 刘洋†笑着说：“只要您坐一次，您就知道了。”

新的火车

4 第二天早上，他们先坐地铁去火车站，再坐火车。车站又大又干净。火车是白色的，很长，也很漂亮。爷爷站在车门口，说：“我七十岁了，还没见过这样的火车。”

5 火车开了。车里很安静，座位也很舒服。爷爷一会儿看看外边，一会儿看看车里，一直在比：“以前的火车没有这么干净。以前的座位没有这么大。以前车里很热，人很多，大家说话的声音都很大……”

6 刘洋听了，问：“爷爷，那现在的火车有不好的地方吗？”爷爷想了想，说：“有。现在的车票比以前贵多了！”两个人都笑了。

† 刘洋 *Liú Yáng* Liu Yang, a student

Liu Yang laughed. "Just ride it once, and you'll see." 3

The New Train

The next morning, they first took the subway to the station, and then the train. The station was big and clean. The train was white, very long and very handsome. Grandpa stood at the train door and said, "I'm seventy years old, and I've never seen a train like this." 4

The train set off. It was quiet inside, and the seats were comfortable. Grandpa kept looking outside and then around the carriage, comparing all the time. "The old trains weren't as clean as this. The old seats weren't as big as this. In the old days it was hot inside, it was packed, and everyone talked loudly..." 5

"So, Grandpa, is there anything bad about today's trains?" asked Liu Yang. Grandpa thought for a moment. "Yes. Tickets cost a lot more than they used to!" They both laughed. 6

7 火车开得非常快，外边的山、河和树一个一个很快就过去了。爷爷说：“以前我在车上看了一天一夜的山。现在我还没看清楚，山就没有了。”十二点半，火车到了西安†。爷爷看了看手表，说：“才四个半小时！”

还在的面馆

8 下了火车，刘洋‡问：“爷爷，我们先去哪儿？”爷爷说：“先去吃面，再去看别的地方。”“四十多年以前，我下了火车，又累又饿，在车站旁边的一个小面馆吃了一大碗面。那是我吃过的最好吃的面。”

9 刘洋说：“四十多年了，那个面馆一定没有了。”爷爷说：“没关系，我们去看看。只要那条路还在，我就能找到。”车站旁边都是新的高楼，爷爷找了半天，走错了两次。

† 西安 *Xī'ān* Xi'an, an old city

‡ 刘洋 *Liú Yáng* Liu Yang, a student

The train went very fast. The hills, rivers and trees outside flashed past one after another. Grandpa said, "Back then I looked at hills for a whole day and night on the train. Now the hills are gone before I've even had a proper look." At half past twelve, the train arrived in Xi'an. Grandpa looked at his watch. "Only four and a half hours!" 7

The Noodle Shop That Was Still There

When they got off the train, Liu Yang asked, "Grandpa, where shall we go first?" "First we eat noodles," said Grandpa, "and then we'll see the other places." "More than forty years ago, I got off the train tired and hungry and had a big bowl of noodles at a little noodle shop near the station. They were the best noodles I've ever eaten." 8

"After more than forty years," said Liu Yang, "that shop must be long gone." "Never mind, let's go and look," said Grandpa. "As long as that street is still there, I can find it." The area around the station was full of new tall buildings. Grandpa searched for ages and took two wrong turns. 9

9 最后，在一条很小的路上，他们看见了一个小面馆。爷爷站在门口，看了很长时间，说：“就在这儿！名字也一样！”

10 面馆的主人是一个五十多岁的男人。他说：“这个面馆是我爸爸开的，现在我来做。”爷爷要了两碗面。面来了，爷爷吃了一口，很长时间没有说话。刘洋†问：“爷爷，跟以前一样吗？”爷爷说：“路变了，楼变了，火车也变了。面没有以前那么便宜了，可是味道一点儿也没变。”

11 他们吃完面，主人笑着说：“欢迎您再来！”爷爷说：“一定来！现在的火车这么快，只要我想吃，早上上车，中午就能来吃。”

† 刘洋 *Liú Yáng* Liu Yang, a student

In the end, on a very narrow street, they saw a little noodle shop. Grandpa stood at the door and looked for a long time. "Here it is! Even the name is the same!" 9

The owner of the shop was a man in his fifties. He said, "My father opened this shop. Now I run it." Grandpa ordered two bowls of noodles. When they came, he took one mouthful and said nothing for a long time. "Grandpa, is it the same as before?" asked Liu Yang. Grandpa said, "The streets have changed, the buildings have changed, and the trains have changed too. The noodles aren't as cheap as they used to be, but the taste hasn't changed one bit." 10

When they had finished, the owner smiled and said, "Do come again!" "I certainly will!" said Grandpa. "The trains are so fast now that whenever I feel like it, I can get on in the morning and be here eating by lunchtime." 11